Shipping and Delivery

Document code SD-03. Version 1.0. Effective 1 January 2024. This is a synthetic policy for the fictional company Northwind Gifts. It is used only for a software demonstration.

1. Dispatch

1.1 Dispatch time. Orders placed before 2pm on a business day are dispatched the same day. Orders placed after 2pm or at the weekend are dispatched on the next business day.

1.2 Business days. A business day is Monday to Friday, excluding public holidays in England. Delivery times in this policy are counted in business days from dispatch.

1.3 Tracking. Northwind Gifts sends a tracking email when the order is dispatched.

2. UK delivery

2.1 UK standard delivery. UK standard delivery takes 3 to 5 business days and costs £3.95. It is free on orders of £40 or more.

2.2 UK next day delivery. UK next day delivery costs £7.95. The order must be placed before 2pm on a business day.

2.3 Remote areas. Deliveries to the Scottish Highlands, Northern Ireland and the Channel Islands have a surcharge of £5.50 and take 2 extra business days.

2.4 Saturday delivery. Saturday delivery is available in the UK mainland for £9.95. The order must be placed before 2pm on Thursday.

3. EU delivery

3.1 EU standard delivery. EU delivery takes 5 to 10 business days and costs £9.95. It is free on orders of £120 or more.

3.2 EU customs. The customer is responsible for any import duties, taxes or customs fees charged by the destination country. Northwind Gifts does not pay these charges.

3.3 No express service. Next day and Saturday delivery are not available for EU addresses.

4. Rest of world delivery

4.1 Rest of world delivery. Delivery outside the UK and EU takes 10 to 20 business days and costs £19.95. It is free on orders of £200 or more.

4.2 Restricted items. Liquids, candles with fragrance oil and aerosols are not shipped outside the UK and EU.

4.3 Customs for rest of world. The customer is responsible for import duties and taxes. Refused parcels are not refunded for the delivery charge.

5. Delivery problems

5.1 Failed delivery. The courier makes 3 delivery attempts. After the third failed attempt the parcel is returned to Northwind Gifts.

5.2 Redelivery fee. If a parcel is returned because nobody was available, redelivery costs £3.50. The customer may ask for a refund instead, less the original delivery charge.

5.3 Lost parcels. If a parcel has not arrived 10 business days after the latest estimated date for UK orders, 20 business days for EU orders, or 30 business days for rest of world orders, the customer may ask for a replacement or a full refund.

5.4 Damaged parcels. A parcel that arrives damaged is handled under the Returns and Refunds policy, which requires a report within 7 days of delivery.

5.5 Wrong address. The customer is responsible for entering the correct address. If a parcel must be redirected, a fee of £5 applies.

6. Wholesale shipping

6.1 Free UK wholesale delivery. Wholesale orders to UK addresses are delivered free when the order value is £500 or more before VAT. Below £500, a flat charge of £15 applies.

6.2 Pallet deliveries. Orders of more than 20 cartons are sent by pallet. The delivery date is agreed with the customer by phone.

6.3 International wholesale. Wholesale deliveries outside the UK are priced by quote.

6.4 Checking deliveries. Wholesale customers must check each delivery within 48 hours and report damage or shortages in that time.

7. Peak season

7.1 Christmas order deadlines. The last order dates for delivery before 25 December are 1 December for rest of world, 8 December for EU, 15 December for UK standard and 22 December for UK next day.

7.2 Peak delays. During November and December, delivery times may be up to 2 business days longer than the times in this policy.

8. Gift orders

8.1 Gift message. A free printed gift message can be added to any order.

8.2 Gift wrap. Gift wrap costs £2.50 per item.

8.3 Separate address. An order can be sent directly to another person. Prices are not shown in the parcel.